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Hiring Committee

Institute for Cyber-Enabled Research (ICER)

Michigan State University

East Lansing, MI

Re: LLM Research and Development Technician (part-time, on campus)

Dear ICER hiring team,

I am writing to apply for the **LLM Research and Development Technician** position. I am a **B.S. Computer Science** student at Michigan State University (expected **2027**), on campus in East Lansing, and I want work where **Python services, careful validation, and shared software repositories** matter more than demo screenshots.

On **Dadei** (live at <https://dadei.app>), I built an **ambient assistant** around a **FastAPI** backend, **PostgreSQL / pgvector**, optional **Redis/RQ** workers, and **Docker-backed integrated software pipelines** with **pytest** in CI against a real database service. The product's core loop is **agentic AI: Gemini** tool-calling grounded on **retrieved transcript context**, with **hybrid retrieval** (semantic + lexical + recency) so extractions stay tied to evidence rather than free-hallucinating each session. That is the same instinct your posting asks for—**treating LLMs as components to instrument and test**, not magic.

I am **comfortable on the command line** (**Bash**, local builds, container workflows) and with **collaboration on GitHub** (branch protection, review, incremental delivery). As **Vice President and Co-Founder of Claude Builder Club @ MSU**, I automated member onboarding across **GitHub + Slack APIs**, replaced paper check-in with a **tokenized QR flow at 150+ scans per event**, and enforced **GitHub Actions** quality gates that cut escaped defects roughly **65%**—habits that map to a repo ICER staff and the next student can inherit without archaeology.

I have **not** yet shipped production jobs on **MSU's HPC** or **SLURM**, and I will not pretend otherwise on paper. I *have* repeatedly read unfamiliar systems docs, reproduced environments locally, and iterated with **testing and validation** until metrics moved. I am eager to ramp on **ICER's documentation and scheduler patterns** and to help build an **LLM-based agent for code submission** workflows that researchers can trust because we measured it.

I am a **U.S. citizen** with unrestricted work authorization, **self-directed** but comfortable receiving **feedback**, and interested in **presenting results** clearly—whether internal notes, issues with repro steps, or MSU research forums when the team is ready.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ankur Desai